

# VerdexAI

## Official User Guide

Complete Reference Manual — Version 1.0 | 2026

|          |                                                                                                         |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Platform | VerdexAI — AI-Powered Recruitment Platform                                                              |
| Live URL | <a href="https://verdexai-official.vercel.app">https://verdexai-official.vercel.app</a>                 |
| Document | User Guide & Feature Reference                                                                          |
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### Project Type

Personal Project — Self-Learning & Portfolio | Independent (No Institutional Affiliation)

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# 1. Introduction & Purpose

VerdexAI is a full-stack AI-powered recruitment platform designed and built independently by Muhammad Ibrahim as a personal project to apply real-world software engineering and AI integration skills in a production-grade environment.

The platform transforms the traditional hiring process by automating CV analysis, candidate scoring, assessment testing, and interview scheduling — all within a single, clean, role-based interface. Every component has been engineered for reliability, scalability, and a polished user experience.

## 1.1 What VerdexAI Does

Core Value Proposition

- Eliminates manual CV screening through AI-driven extraction and match scoring
- Gives HR teams a ranked, explainable view of every applicant
- Automates assessment test generation, delivery, and grading
- Streamlines interview scheduling with email notifications and meeting links
- Tracks the full pipeline from application to onboarding in one dashboard

## 1.2 Technology Foundation

VerdexAI is built with modern, production-grade technologies:

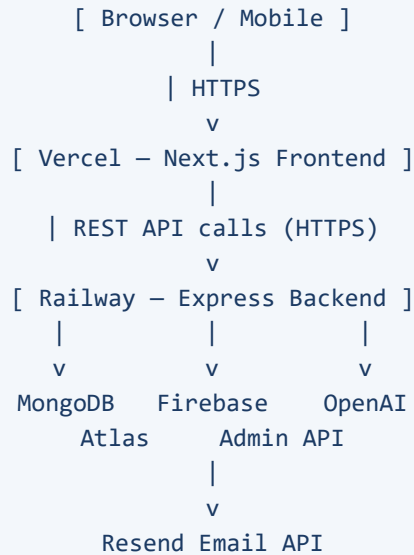
|               |                                                     |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Frontend      | Next.js 15 (App Router), React 19, Tailwind CSS 4   |
| Backend       | Node.js, Express.js, Mongoose (MongoDB ODM)         |
| Database      | MongoDB Atlas (cloud, Singapore region)             |
| Auth          | Firebase Authentication (Email/Password)            |
| AI Engine     | OpenAI GPT-4o-mini (CV parsing & candidate scoring) |
| Email         | Resend API (interview notifications, contact form)  |
| Frontend Host | Vercel (automatic CI/CD from GitHub)                |
| Backend Host  | Railway (persistent Node.js server)                 |

## 1.3 Scope of This Document

This guide covers every feature available in VerdexAI for all three user roles: Candidate, HR/Recruiter, and Admin. It is written for end users — no technical background is required. Each section follows a consistent structure: feature overview → step-by-step instructions → what to expect.

## 2. System Architecture Overview

Understanding VerdexAI's architecture helps users understand why certain things happen — for example, why the first request after the backend sleeps takes a few seconds to respond.



### 2.1 Request Flow

1. User opens the browser and visits <https://verdexai-official.vercel.app>
2. Vercel serves the Next.js frontend instantly from its CDN
3. When the user logs in, Firebase Auth verifies credentials and returns a secure ID token
4. All API calls send this token in the Authorization header to the Railway backend
5. The backend verifies the token with Firebase Admin SDK, checks the user's role in MongoDB, then processes the request
6. AI operations (CV parsing, scoring, question generation) call OpenAI's API and return structured JSON
7. Email notifications use the Resend API and are sent asynchronously so they don't slow down the main request

### 2.2 Important Notes for Users

#### Free-Tier Behaviour

- The backend runs on Railway's free tier and may take 20-30 seconds to respond to the first request after a period of inactivity (cold start). This is normal — wait and retry.
- MongoDB Atlas free tier has a 512 MB storage cap. Sufficient for all demo and FYP purposes.
- OpenAI API calls (CV parsing, test generation) add 3-8 seconds to submission responses.

### 3. Platform Roles & Access Levels

VerdexAI uses a three-role access control system. Each role has its own dedicated dashboard, navigation, and feature set. You select your role at signup (Candidate or HR); Admin accounts are assigned manually by the platform owner.

| Role           | Dashboard            | Key Capabilities                                                                                 |
|----------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Candidate      | /candidate/dashboard | Browse jobs, apply with CV, take tests, see interview details, track onboarding                  |
| HR / Recruiter | /hr/dashboard        | Post jobs, review AI rankings, send tests, schedule interviews, finalize hires, track onboarding |
| Admin          | /admin/hr            | View platform stats, manage HR accounts (activate/suspend)                                       |

### 4. Getting Started — Account Setup

#### 4.1 Creating an Account

Navigate to <https://verdexai-official.vercel.app> and click Sign Up in the top navigation bar. Complete the registration form:

| Step | Action                                         | Expected Result                                       |
|------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Enter your Full Name (minimum 2 characters)    | Name field turns green when valid                     |
| 2    | Enter a valid Email Address                    | Email is used for login and notifications             |
| 3    | Select your Role — Candidate or HR / Recruiter | Determines which dashboard you see after login        |
| 4    | Create a Password (minimum 8 characters)       | Strength indicator shows: Weak / Fair / Good / Strong |
| 5    | Re-enter password in Confirm Password field    | Both fields must match exactly                        |
| 6    | Click Sign Up                                  | Redirected to your role dashboard automatically       |

**Important**

- Admin accounts are NOT available through the signup form. Admin access is granted manually by the platform owner.
- Your email address is used to receive interview notifications — ensure it is valid and accessible.
- You cannot change your role after signup without contacting the platform owner.

## 4.2 Logging In

Click Sign In on the landing page. Enter your registered email and password, then click Sign In. You will be redirected automatically based on your role: Candidate → /candidate/dashboard, HR → /hr/dashboard, Admin → /admin/hr.

## 4.3 Resetting Your Password

On the login page, click Forgot password? — enter your registered email and click Send Reset Link. A password reset email from Firebase Authentication will arrive within 1–2 minutes. Check your spam folder if you do not see it in your inbox. Click the link in the email and set a new password.

# 5. Candidate Guide

This section covers everything a job-seeking candidate needs to know — from browsing positions to tracking your onboarding after being hired.

## 5.1 Dashboard Overview

After logging in as a Candidate, your dashboard displays four real-time stat cards at the top:

|                          |                                                              |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Applications Sent</b> | Total number of jobs you have applied to                     |
| <b>Shortlisted</b>       | Applications where the HR team has marked you as shortlisted |
| <b>Interviews</b>        | Number of scheduled interviews you currently have upcoming   |
| <b>Hired</b>             | Positions where you have been successfully hired             |

Below the stats, the dashboard shows two sections:

- **Upcoming Interviews** — displays any interview cards with full details (date, time, platform, meeting link, HR notes). This section only appears if you have at least one scheduled interview.
- **All Applications** — a complete table listing every job you have applied to, showing job title, department, date applied, and current application status.

Application statuses and their meanings:

|                            |                                                                                  |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Submitted</b>           | Your application was received and is waiting for HR to review                    |
| <b>Under Review</b>        | HR is actively reviewing your application and CV data                            |
| <b>Shortlisted</b>         | HR has decided to proceed with you — expect a test or interview soon             |
| <b>Interview Scheduled</b> | An interview has been booked — check the Upcoming Interviews section for details |
| <b>Rejected</b>            | HR has decided not to proceed with your application for this role                |

|       |                                                                        |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hired | Congratulations — you have been hired. Check Onboarding for next steps |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|

5.2 Browsing & Applying to Jobs

Click Browse Jobs in the left sidebar to see all currently open positions. Each job card displays:

- Job title and department
- A preview of the job description
- An Apply Now button

If you have previously applied to any job with a CV upload, your AI-Extracted Profile appears as a card at the top of the Browse Jobs page. This shows the skills, experience, education, and professional summary that the AI parsed from your last uploaded resume — so you can see exactly what HR sees.

5.3 CV Upload & AI Profile Extraction

When you click Apply Now on a job card, you reach the Application Form. This is where VerdexAI's core AI capability activates.

| Step | Action                                                                  | Expected Result                                                |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Read the full Job Description and Requirements shown above the form     | Helps you tailor your cover letter                             |
| 2    | Click the CV file input and select your resume as a PDF file (max 5 MB) | File name appears below the input confirming selection         |
| 3    | Write your Cover Letter in the text area                                | Explain why you are a strong fit for this specific role        |
| 4    | Click Submit Application                                                | Loading state: 'Submitting & Analyzing...' — wait 5-10 seconds |
| 5    | Success message appears and you are redirected to the dashboard         | Application shows in your table with status 'Submitted'        |

How AI Scoring Works — Behind the Scenes

When you submit:

1. The backend extracts all text from your PDF using pdf-parse
2. That text is sent to OpenAI GPT-4o-mini with a structured prompt
3. OpenAI extracts: Name, Email, Phone, Skills (array), Experience Years, Education, Summary
4. A second AI call scores how well your profile matches the job's requirements (0-100%)
5. The score and a reasoning explanation are stored — visible to HR on their Ranked Candidates page
6. You do not see your own score, but HR's ranking is based entirely on this AI-generated number

**Tips for a Higher AI Score**

- Use a clean, text-based PDF (not a scanned image). AI cannot read image-only files.
- Include specific skill keywords from the job requirements in your resume.
- Clearly state your years of experience — the AI extracts this as a number.
- Add an education section with your degree, institution, and graduation year.
- Avoid tables and graphics inside the PDF — plain text parses more accurately.

## 5.4 My Tests — Assessment Engine

When an HR team member sends you an assessment test, it becomes visible in the My Tests section (accessible from the left sidebar).

Each test invitation card shows:

- The job title the test is for
- The time limit (typically 30 minutes)
- The expiry date (tests expire 7 days after being sent)
- Status: Pending / Completed / Expired

Click Start Test on a Pending invitation to begin.

### 5.4.1 The Test Interface

The test opens in a focused, full-screen-style interface with no distractions. At the top you will see:

- Job title (confirms which role this test is for)
- Countdown timer (top right) — turns red when under 2 minutes remaining
- Tab switch counter — increments if you switch to another browser tab or application

The test consists of exactly 10 multiple-choice questions, each with four options (A, B, C, D). Questions are AI-generated specifically for the job role and its requirements — a Python Developer test will have different questions than an AI Engineer test.

### 5.4.2 Navigating Questions

| Step | Action                                                                    | Expected Result                                               |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Read the question and click one of the four option buttons                | Selected option highlights in blue                            |
| 2    | Click Next to advance or Previous to go back                              | You can revisit and change answers any time before submitting |
| 3    | Use the numbered dots below the question to jump to any specific question | Answered questions show as filled dots; unanswered as empty   |

| Step | Action                                                            | Expected Result                                                     |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4    | When ready, click Submit Test (visible when on the last question) | Confirmation prompt appears if any questions are unanswered         |
| 5    | Timer reaches zero                                                | Test is auto-submitted with your current answers — no action needed |

### Proctoring — Tab Switch Tracking

VerdexAI tracks how many times you switch away from the test browser tab.

- A counter in the top bar shows your current tab-switch count
- This count is recorded and visible to HR on the test results
- Stay on the test tab for the entire duration
- Switching to check reference material is recorded — treat this as an integrity measure

### 5.4.3 Test Results Page

After submitting, you are redirected to a results page showing:

- Score percentage — large display in green (if  $\geq 60\%$ ) or red (if below 60%)
- Correct / Total — for example: '7 out of 10 correct'
- Time Taken — how long you spent on the test
- Tab Switches — how many times you switched away from the test

Click Review Answers to see a complete breakdown of all 10 questions. For each question:

- The correct answer is highlighted in blue with the label '(Correct)'
- Any wrong answer you selected is highlighted in red with '(Your answer)'
- An explanation is shown beneath each question describing why the correct answer is right

## 5.5 Interview Details & Meeting Links

When an HR team schedules an interview with you, two things happen simultaneously:

| Email Notification                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Dashboard Card                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ An email is sent to your registered address immediately</li> <li>▪ Subject: 'Interview Scheduled — [Job Title]'</li> <li>▪ Contains: date/time (PKT), duration, platform, meeting link, HR notes</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ An interview card appears on your dashboard under Upcoming Interviews</li> <li>▪ Shows: date/time, platform icon, meeting link as a clickable 'Join Meeting' button</li> <li>▪ Also shows any notes the HR team added for your preparation</li> </ul> |

|                                                                                                          |                                                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ Sent from: VerdexAI notification system via Resend API</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ Card remains visible until the interview status changes</li></ul> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

Interview Preparation Tips

- Save the meeting link from your email before the interview day
- Join 5 minutes early to test your audio, video, and screen sharing
- Read the 'Notes from HR' section carefully — it may specify topics to prepare
- Have your resume and GitHub profile accessible during the interview
- The 'Join Meeting' link on your dashboard works on both desktop and mobile

5.6 Onboarding Tracker

After being hired, your Onboarding page (accessible from the sidebar) shows your onboarding progress as a step-by-step checklist. If you have not been hired yet, the page shows a 'No active onboarding yet' message.

The onboarding checklist contains five standard steps managed by the HR team:

|                             |                                                           |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Step 1: Offer Letter Sent   | HR has formally sent your employment offer letter         |
| Step 2: Offer Accepted      | Your acceptance of the offer has been confirmed           |
| Step 3: Documents Submitted | You have submitted the required joining documentation     |
| Step 4: IT Account Setup    | Your accounts, email, and system access have been created |
| Step 5: First Day Scheduled | Your first working day has been set                       |

A progress bar at the top of your onboarding card fills as each step is marked complete by HR. You cannot toggle these steps yourself — they are controlled by the HR team. If there is a discrepancy, contact your HR representative directly.

6. HR / Recruiter Guide

This section covers all tools available to an HR or Recruiter account. As HR, you control the entire hiring pipeline — from publishing jobs to tracking the onboarding of hired candidates.

6.1 HR Dashboard

The HR dashboard provides a real-time summary of your hiring pipeline through four stat cards:

|                  |                                                                          |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Active Job Posts | Number of jobs you have posted with Open status (accepting applications) |
| Total Applicants | Combined total of all candidates who have applied to any of your jobs    |

|                    |                                                                                |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Shortlisted</b> | Candidates whose status you have changed to Shortlisted or Interview Scheduled |
| <b>Hired</b>       | Candidates you have finalized as hired through the Finalize Hire page          |

Below the stats, a table lists all your job posts with the applicant count per role. Click Job Postings in the sidebar to manage them or create new ones.

## 6.2 Creating & Managing Job Posts

Click Job Postings in the sidebar. The top half of the page contains the creation form; the bottom half shows your existing posts.

### 6.2.1 Creating a New Job Post

| Step | Action                                                           | Expected Result                                                       |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Enter the Job Title (e.g. 'Python Developer')                    | Clear, specific title helps AI generate better test questions         |
| 2    | Enter the Department (e.g. 'Engineering')                        | Used for display and organisational categorisation                    |
| 3    | Write a detailed Description of the role                         | What the candidate will do day-to-day                                 |
| 4    | Write detailed Requirements (skills, experience, qualifications) | CRITICAL — AI uses this to score all applicants against the role      |
| 5    | Click Publish Job                                                | Job appears immediately in the live platform and candidates can apply |

#### Requirements Quality = AI Score Quality

The Requirements field is the most important field in the job post. The AI uses it to evaluate every candidate's CV against specific criteria. Vague requirements produce vague scores. Be specific:

- List exact technologies (e.g. 'Python, FastAPI, MongoDB' not just 'backend skills')
- Specify experience level (e.g. '1-3 years' or 'final year students welcome')
- Include both must-have and nice-to-have items

### 6.2.2 Closing a Job Post

In your existing job posts list, each Open job has a red Close button on the right. Clicking it shows a confirmation prompt. Once closed, the job no longer appears on the candidate Browse Jobs page and no new applications can be submitted. Existing applications are unaffected.

## 6.3 AI-Ranked Candidates

The Ranked Candidates page is the core of VerdexAI's intelligence. It shows all candidates who have applied to your jobs, sorted by their AI match score from highest to lowest.

Each row displays:

- Candidate name (AI-extracted from their CV, not their account name)
- The job title they applied to
- A visual score bar and percentage (e.g. 84%)
- A status dropdown for updating their pipeline stage

Click any row to expand it and reveal full candidate details:

- Email address for direct contact
- AI Reasoning — a 1-2 sentence explanation of why the candidate received that score
- Skills — an array extracted from the CV (e.g. ['Python', 'FastAPI', 'MongoDB', 'LangChain'])
- Experience — years of experience detected from the CV
- Education — highest qualification identified
- Cover Letter — the text the candidate wrote when applying
- Test Score Badge — if the candidate has completed an assessment test, their score appears here

### 6.3.1 Updating Candidate Status

Use the dropdown on each candidate row to move them through the pipeline:

|                            |                                                                           |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Submitted</b>           | Default — candidate applied, not yet reviewed by HR                       |
| <b>Under Review</b>        | You are actively evaluating this candidate                                |
| <b>Shortlisted</b>         | You want to proceed — candidate may receive a test or interview           |
| <b>Interview Scheduled</b> | An interview has been arranged (auto-set when you use Schedule Interview) |
| <b>Rejected</b>            | You are not proceeding with this candidate                                |

## 6.4 Assessment Test Invitations

From the Ranked Candidates page, expand any candidate row and click Send Assessment Test. VerdexAI will:

1. Check if an MCQ question pool already exists for this job — if not, call OpenAI to generate 10 role-specific questions
2. Create a test invitation for the candidate with a 30-minute time limit and 7-day expiry
3. Automatically update the candidate's application status to Interview Scheduled
4. Display the invitation in the candidate's My Tests section immediately

You will see a success alert confirming the invitation was sent. The candidate does not receive an email for the test itself — they see it when they next log in to their dashboard. To send them a notification about the test, send a custom email or include a note in the interview scheduling.

Test Question Generation

- Questions are AI-generated based on the job's Title, Department, and Requirements fields
- Once generated, the same question pool is reused for all candidates applying to the same job
- This ensures consistency and fairness across all applicants for that role
- If AI generation fails, a set of 10 universal technical fallback questions is used automatically

6.5 Interview Scheduling

From the Ranked Candidates page, expand any candidate row and click Schedule Interview. A modal dialog opens with the following fields:

|                     |                                                                                                                            |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Date & Time         | Select the interview date and start time using the date-time picker                                                        |
| Duration            | How long the interview will run (15 to 120 minutes)                                                                        |
| Platform            | Select: Google Meet, Zoom, Microsoft Teams, or Other                                                                       |
| Meeting Link        | Paste the full URL of the video call (e.g. <a href="https://meet.google.com/abc-xyz">https://meet.google.com/abc-xyz</a> ) |
| Notes for Candidate | Preparation instructions, topics to cover, or any other information                                                        |

Click Schedule & Notify Candidate. The system will:

1. Save the interview record with all details
2. Automatically update the candidate's status to Interview Scheduled
3. Send an instant email to the candidate's registered address with all interview details
4. Make the interview card visible on the candidate's dashboard immediately

To reschedule an existing interview, open the Schedule Interview modal for the same candidate again, fill in the new details, and click Schedule & Notify Candidate. The candidate will receive a new email marked as Rescheduled.

6.6 Finalizing a Hire

Once you have made your hiring decision, navigate to Finalize Hire in the sidebar. Only candidates with status Shortlisted or Interview Scheduled appear in the dropdown. Candidates who are still Submitted or Under Review are not eligible to be finalized.

| Step | Action                                             | Expected Result                                                            |
|------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Select the candidate from the dropdown             | List shows: 'Name — Job Title (current status)'                            |
| 2    | Set a Start Date (when they will join the company) | Optional but recommended — shown in their onboarding record                |
| 3    | Click Confirm Hire                                 | Success message: 'Candidate successfully hired. Onboarding entry created.' |
| 4    | The application status updates to Hired            | Candidate appears in the Hired stat count on your dashboard                |
| 5    | An onboarding record is created automatically      | Visible immediately on the Onboarding page                                 |

## 6.7 Onboarding Management

After finalizing a hire, navigate to Onboarding in the sidebar. Each hired candidate appears as a card containing their name, the role they were hired for, the start date, and five onboarding steps.

Click any step button to toggle it between complete and incomplete. The progress bar updates immediately. The candidate sees the same steps and progress on their own Onboarding page in real time.

|                            |                                                            |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Offer Letter Sent</b>   | Toggle ON when you have formally sent the employment offer |
| <b>Offer Accepted</b>      | Toggle ON when the candidate has confirmed acceptance      |
| <b>Documents Submitted</b> | Toggle ON when all required joining documents are received |
| <b>IT Account Setup</b>    | Toggle ON when accounts, email, and access are provisioned |
| <b>First Day Scheduled</b> | Toggle ON when the first working day is confirmed          |

## 7. Admin Guide

The Admin role has access to platform-wide management tools. Log in with an Admin account — you will be automatically redirected to /admin/hr.

### 7.1 Platform Statistics

The top of the Admin dashboard shows four real-time stats pulled from MongoDB:

|                           |                                                                     |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Total HR Accounts</b>  | Number of users registered with the HR / Recruiter role             |
| <b>Total Candidates</b>   | Number of users registered with the Candidate role                  |
| <b>Total Job Posts</b>    | Total job postings created across all HR accounts (open and closed) |
| <b>Total Applications</b> | Total applications submitted across all jobs and all candidates     |

## 7.2 Managing HR Accounts

Below the stats, a table lists all HR accounts with their name, email, and current status (Active or Suspended).

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Suspending an HR Account</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ Click Suspend on an Active HR account</li><li>▪ Status badge changes to red 'Suspended'</li><li>▪ HR user cannot perform any HR actions while suspended</li><li>▪ Use when an HR account should be temporarily disabled</li></ul> | <p><b>Activating an HR Account</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ Click Activate on a Suspended HR account</li><li>▪ Status badge changes to blue 'Active'</li><li>▪ HR user regains full access immediately</li><li>▪ Use to restore access after resolving issues</li></ul> |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Admin Limitations</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ Admin accounts cannot be suspended through this interface — only HR and Candidate accounts are manageable</li><li>▪ Admin cannot create new HR accounts through the UI — HR must sign up themselves</li><li>▪ Suspension is reversible at any time — no data is deleted when an account is suspended</li></ul> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## 8. Email Notification System

VerdexAI sends automated emails through the Resend API. All notifications are sent from the platform sender address. The following events trigger automatic emails:

| Event                                    | Recipient      | Email Contains                                                                |
|------------------------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| HR changes status to Interview Scheduled | Candidate      | Notification that application progressed; prompts to check dashboard for test |
| HR schedules an interview                | Candidate      | Date/time, duration, platform, clickable meeting link, HR notes               |
| HR reschedules an interview              | Candidate      | All updated details, marked as Rescheduled                                    |
| Contact form submitted on landing page   | Platform Owner | Sender name, email, subject, and full message body                            |
| Password reset requested                 | Account Owner  | Secure reset link from Firebase Authentication                                |

## 9. Security & Data Handling

- Authentication is handled entirely by Firebase Authentication — passwords are never stored in VerdexAI's own database

- Every authenticated API request sends a short-lived Firebase ID token that the backend verifies before processing any data
- Role-based access control is enforced on both the frontend (routing) and the backend (middleware on every protected endpoint)
- CV files are processed in memory only — they are never saved to disk or any file storage service. The extracted text and AI analysis are stored; the PDF itself is discarded after processing
- OpenAI receives only CV text and job description text — no personal account data or authentication credentials
- Environment variables containing API keys and credentials are stored in Railway and Vercel's secure environment variable vaults — never in the codebase or Git repository
- The .env file is explicitly excluded from version control via .gitignore

## 10. Troubleshooting & FAQ

| Issue / Question                                               | Solution                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| First page load is very slow (20-30 seconds)                   | The Railway backend spins down after inactivity. Wait for the cold start and retry — subsequent requests will be fast.                                                            |
| Login is failing with 'Something went wrong'                   | Ensure your email and password are correct. Use Forgot Password to reset. Check that you are using the same email you signed up with.                                             |
| I signed up but see the wrong dashboard                        | Your role was set at signup and cannot be changed through the UI. Contact the platform owner to update your role in the database.                                                 |
| My CV was submitted but shows 'AI analysis pending' in HR view | AI processing failed for that submission (usually a network/API error). Submit a new application with a fresh PDF. Ensure the PDF contains selectable text (not a scanned image). |
| The interview email never arrived                              | Check your spam/junk folder. Emails come from the Resend API sender address. Ensure your registered email is correct by checking your profile.                                    |
| The test timer ran out and I did not submit                    | The test auto-submits when the timer reaches zero with whatever answers you had selected at that point.                                                                           |
| I cannot see the Schedule Interview button                     | Expand the candidate's row fully on the Ranked Candidates page. Ensure you are logged in as HR (not Admin or Candidate). The button only appears for non-hired candidates.        |
| The candidate does not appear in Finalize Hire dropdown        | Only candidates with status Shortlisted or Interview Scheduled appear. Change the candidate's status on the Ranked Candidates page first.                                         |
| Contact form shows an error message                            | The backend may be experiencing a cold start. Wait 30 seconds and try again. Ensure all fields (Name, Email, Subject, Message) are filled.                                        |
| CV upload says 'Only PDF files are allowed'                    | Ensure your file has a .pdf extension and is actually a PDF (not a .docx renamed to .pdf). Maximum file size is 5 MB.                                                             |
| I need to change my email address                              | Email change is not supported through the UI. Contact the platform owner.                                                                                                         |

| Issue / Question                  | Solution                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dark mode / light mode preference | The landing page has a theme toggle button in the top navigation bar. Dashboards follow your system theme. |

## 11. Contact & Support

VerdexAI is developed and maintained independently by Muhammad Ibrahim. For questions, bug reports, collaboration inquiries, or feedback, use any of the following channels:

**Muhammad Ibrahim — Developer**  
Full Stack & AI Engineer  
Jamshoro, Sindh, Pakistan | Remote-Friendly  
  
**Email:** mibrahimkhalid306@gmail.com  
**GitHub:** github.com/mibrahim-O2  
**LinkedIn:** linkedin.com/in/muhammad-ibrahim-o2  
**X -Twitter:** x.com/MIbraheem\_02  
**Facebook:** facebook.com/mibrahim.O2/  
**Phone:** +92 324 2991303

Alternatively, use the Contact Form on the live platform at the bottom of the landing page: <https://verdexai-official.vercel.app/#contact>

When reporting a bug, please include:

- Your role (Candidate, HR, or Admin)
- The browser and device you were using
- The exact page URL where the issue occurred
- A description of what you expected vs. what happened
- Any error messages visible on screen or in the browser console (F12)